"I'm helpless."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When a body or mind limits what we can do, tasks that were easy become hard and we depend on others. Over time, "I need help with some things" can become "I am helpless."

What Scripture teaches

"God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble." "The LORD is my helper; I will not be afraid." "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength." Even when we need much help from others, we still have prayer, love, wisdom, and presence to give, and we are never helpless before God: "You hold my right hand." Dependence is part of how God made us all.

> *"So we say with confidence: 'The Lord is my helper; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?'"* (Hebrews 13:6).

Also see

> "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble" (Psalm 46:1).

> "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength" (Philippians 4:13).

> "Yet I am always with You; You hold my right hand" (Psalm 73:23).

> "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness" (Isaiah 41:10).

Common self-statements

- I cannot do anything.
- I am useless.
- I depend on everyone.
- I have no power.
- I am trapped.
- I cannot help myself.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either independent or helpless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be capable.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling dependent and concluding that I am helpless.
- Labeling: Calling myself helpless.

Challenging questions

- What can I still do, even if differently?
- What aids or adaptations could increase my independence?
- What can I give to others?
- What does God say about helping those who depend on Him?

- Who helps me, and what do they receive from helping?
- What is one task I can reclaim?

Truth summary

> I am not helpless. I can do many things, in my own way and with help. God is my helper, and I have much to give.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Trust
- Hopeless
- Humility
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm helpless"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm helpless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What can I still do, even if differently?
- ☐ What aids or adaptations could increase my independence?
- ☐ What can I give to others?
- ☐ What does God say about helping those who depend on Him?
- ☐ Who helps me, and what do they receive from helping?
- ☐ What is one task I can reclaim?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord is my helper.
- ☐ God is my refuge and strength.
- ☐ I can do all things through Christ.
- ☐ God holds my right hand.
- ☐ I can still give.
- ☐ Help is not weakness.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Hebrews 13:6**
  "So we say with confidence: 'The Lord is my helper; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?'"
- ☐ **Psalm 46:1**
  "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:13**
  "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I can do: Each week, note one thing you did yourself and one thing you gave.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Hebrews 13:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord is my helper.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List abilities. Write what you can do.
- [ ] Try adaptive tools. Ask an occupational therapist.
- [ ] Give something. Pray, call, or listen.
- [ ] Memorize Hebrews 13:6. Say it when you feel helpless.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm helpless": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	What I can do
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm helpless.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel helpless. You are my helper. Show me what I can still do, send practical help, and let me give from where I am. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.